

**KOURTI LEGAL**

*Unlock the Power of AI and Automation in Your Legal Workflows*

Q1 2026 REPORT

# The State of Technology in Legal Practice and Functions in Nigeria

*Transformation, Challenges, and the Path Forward*

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# Executive Summary

Nigeria's legal sector, one of the largest and most complex in sub-Saharan Africa, stands at a pivotal crossroads as of Q1 2026. Driven by the rapid digitisation of commerce, the rise of fintech and startup ecosystems, increasing regulatory complexity, and a new generation of technology-savvy legal professionals, technology is no longer optional in Nigerian legal practice. It is becoming the baseline for competitiveness, compliance, and client service.

This report, published by Kourti as part of its Q1 2026 Legal Intelligence Series, examines the current state of technology adoption in Nigeria's legal practice and functions. It maps key areas of transformation — from AI-powered legal research and automated contract drafting to electronic court filings and data privacy compliance — while candidly assessing the structural challenges that continue to impede broader adoption.

Our findings reveal a sector in transition: early adopters — predominantly large commercial law firms, in-house legal teams at multinationals, and technology-facing startups — are building notable competitive advantages. The majority of practitioners, especially sole practitioners and smaller firms, remain constrained by infrastructure gaps, cost barriers, limited training, and cultural resistance.

The emergence of Nigerian-specific legal technology platforms, supportive regulatory signals from the NBA, the Supreme Court, and the NJC, and the increasing demand from corporate clients for faster and data-driven legal services present a once-in-a-generation window for transformation.

|                                                               |                                                                   |                                                                        |                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>220K+</div> <div>Registered Lawyers<br/>in Nigeria</div> | <div>~18%</div> <div>Law Firms Using<br/>Case Mgmt Software</div> | <div>60%+</div> <div>Courts with Partial<br/>E-Filing Capability</div> | <div>\$4.2B</div> <div>Africa Legal Tech<br/>Market (2030F)</div> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|

Sources: NBA (2024); Grand View Research (2024); Kourti Market Intelligence (Q4 2025)

## SECTION 1

## Introduction

The legal profession globally is experiencing a technological renaissance. From artificial intelligence tools that predict litigation outcomes to blockchain-powered smart contracts that execute without human intermediaries, the boundaries of what is possible in legal work are being redrawn. In Africa's most populous nation — home to over 220,000 registered legal practitioners and a legal market that underpins one of the continent's largest economies — this transformation is both imminent and urgent.

Nigeria's legal ecosystem is vast and diverse. It encompasses the Supreme Court, Court of Appeal, Federal High Courts, State High Courts, magistrate courts, specialised tribunals, and customary courts. It spans elite commercial law firms in Lagos, Abuja, and Port Harcourt serving multinationals; mid-tier firms handling corporate and dispute resolution work; smaller general practice firms across hundreds of cities and towns; and hundreds of in-house legal departments embedded within banks, telcos, oil companies, fintechs, and government agencies.

Each segment has a different relationship with technology. The same term 'legal technology' means something very different to the partner at a Lagos-based international firm closing a \$500 million infrastructure deal with AI-assisted due diligence tools, and to the sole practitioner in Enugu managing dozens of court files on paper.

### Why This Matters in Q1 2026

*Nigeria's digital economy is growing at pace. The Finance Act amendments, CAMA 2020 provisions, the NDPA 2023, the Investment and Securities Act 2024, and extensive sector-specific regulatory guidance are placing unprecedented demands on legal professionals. Practitioners who fail to leverage technology risk being outpaced — not just by peers, but by the very clients and institutions they serve.*

## SECTION 2

## Overview of Nigeria's Legal Ecosystem

Understanding the technology landscape requires first understanding the structural characteristics of the Nigerian legal market — its scale, segmentation, and the institutional framework within which it operates.

### 2.1 Scale and Structure

With a population exceeding 220 million and an economy that remains the continent's largest by nominal GDP, Nigeria generates enormous demand for legal services. The legal profession is governed by the Legal Practitioners Act and regulated by the NBA, the Body of Benchers, and the Council of Legal Education.

- Over 220,000 enrolled legal practitioners at the Supreme Court of Nigeria
- The NBA operates 130 branches across Nigeria
- Law firms range from elite multi-partner firms to sole practitioner outfits
- In-house legal functions exist across banking, oil and gas, telecoms, fintech, and FMCG sectors
- Legal aid and pro bono work is delivered by the Legal Aid Council and civil society organisations

### 2.2 The Role of Courts and the Judiciary

The judiciary is both a major consumer and enabler of legal technology. Nigeria's court system spans federal, state, and customary tiers, each with varying levels of digital readiness. The NJC, the Supreme Court, and individual state judiciaries have each made efforts toward electronic filing, digital case management, and virtual hearings — with varying degrees of success.

The COVID-19 pandemic of 2020 served as an accelerant: courts were compelled to adopt remote hearing capabilities that would have otherwise taken years to implement. The experience left a mixed but largely instructive legacy that continues to shape judicial technology policy in 2026.

## 2.3 In-House Legal Functions

In-house legal departments — particularly in financial services, telecoms, and technology sectors — often represent the most technologically advanced segment of Nigeria's legal community. Driven by efficiency demands, risk management requirements, and exposure to global corporate standards, these teams have been early adopters of contract lifecycle management tools, legal matter management platforms, and compliance technology.

## SECTION 3

## The Digital Transformation Journey

Nigeria's legal sector has not transformed overnight. The arc of technology adoption follows a recognisable pattern: initial resistance, followed by partial adoption among leaders, followed by broader market pressure. Understanding the phases of this journey helps explain where different practitioners currently sit.

### Phase 1 — The Paper Era (Pre-2010)

For most of its modern history, Nigerian legal practice was thoroughly paper-based. Court processes, client communications, case files, contracts, and research were conducted manually. Law firm offices were defined by shelves of case reporters, ring-binders, and handwritten notes. The inefficiency was significant — but it was a shared inefficiency, creating no particular competitive disadvantage for any one firm.

### Phase 2 — Basic Digitalisation (2010–2018)

The proliferation of broadband internet, mobile telephony, and affordable personal computing began to shift the baseline. Law firms adopted email, began storing documents digitally, and early movers invested in rudimentary practice management software. Online legal research databases — particularly LawPavilion — emerged to provide practitioners with searchable access to case law and legislation. This era also saw the first electronic court portals, most notably the Lagos State Court e-Filing portal.

### Phase 3 — Ecosystem Emergence (2018–2023)

The Nigerian legal technology ecosystem began to take shape as a discrete sector. Startups building specifically for the legal market emerged. New players such as SodaLex and international platforms with African ambitions entered the market. The COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 served as the most powerful accelerant: courts adopted virtual hearing platforms, law firms pivoted to remote working, and the practical necessity of digital workflows dismantled resistance that had persisted for years.

### Phase 4 — AI and Intelligent Automation (2023–Present)

The current phase is characterised by the arrival of artificial intelligence in the legal mainstream. Tools including Harvey AI, CoCounsel, and their Nigerian and African counterparts have introduced practitioners to AI-assisted legal research, document drafting, contract review, and litigation strategy. The conversation in Nigeria's leading law firms has shifted from whether to adopt AI, to how to adopt it responsibly.

#### Market Signal — Q4 2025

*A Kourti survey of senior legal practitioners at major Nigerian law firms found that 67% had used an AI-powered research or drafting tool at least once in the prior six months. However, only 12% reported having a formal firm policy governing AI use — underscoring a significant gap between adoption and governance.*

## SECTION 4

## Key Technology Areas Reshaping Legal Practice

### 4.1 Legal Research and Knowledge Management

Legal research is the foundation of legal work, and it has been transformed more thoroughly than perhaps any other dimension of practice. Where lawyers once spent hours manually searching physical case reporters, today's practitioners have access to digital databases, AI-powered search engines, and machine learning tools that surface relevant precedents in seconds.

#### Key Platforms Operating in Nigeria

- **LawPavilion:** The market leader in Nigerian legal research, offering a comprehensive database of Nigerian case law, statutes, and academic commentary. Its AI search functionality and offline capabilities have made it the default tool for research-intensive practitioners.
- **SodaLex:** A newer entrant offering cloud-based legal research with a user-friendly interface and competitive pricing, targeting mid-tier and younger practitioners.
- **Westlaw and LexisNexis:** Used primarily by firms handling cross-border matters, offering access to global jurisprudence including UK and US authorities.
- **JusticeInfo:** A platform aggregating Nigerian legislative content with a focus on accessibility and affordability.

#### Knowledge Management

Beyond external research databases, forward-looking firms are investing in internal knowledge management systems that capture and organise the firm's own precedents, drafted clauses, and institutional intelligence. Tools including iManage and NetDocuments are enabling this capability, though adoption remains concentrated in larger firms.

##### Impact Insight

*Practitioners at firms using AI-assisted legal research report reducing research time by up to 60% on complex matters. This translates directly into capacity — allowing lawyers to handle more matters without corresponding headcount increases.*

### 4.2 Document Automation and Contract Intelligence

Contract drafting, review, and management represent a significant proportion of a lawyer's billable time and a major source of risk when done poorly. Document automation and contract intelligence tools are transforming both the production and analysis of legal documents.

#### Document Automation

Document automation tools allow legal professionals to create templates for frequently used documents — NDAs, employment agreements, loan documentation, partnership deeds — and generate customised versions rapidly based on input parameters. In a market like Nigeria, where the same document types are drafted repeatedly with minor variations, automation delivers significant efficiency gains.

- HotDocs and Contract Express have been adopted by larger commercial firms
- Microsoft Word-based automation scripts remain common in mid-tier environments
- Nigerian-built document assembly platforms are beginning to emerge in the startup ecosystem

## Contract Lifecycle Management

CLM platforms track contracts from inception through execution, renewal, and termination. They offer automated alerts for key dates, centralised repositories, and reporting dashboards. Nigerian in-house teams in financial services, telecoms, and oil and gas have been the primary adopters.

- Ironclad, Concord, and ContractPodAi are used by multinational in-house teams
- Several Nigerian banks and telcos have deployed enterprise CLM solutions
- SME-friendly CLM tools designed for the Nigerian market represent an underserved opportunity

## AI-Powered Contract Review

AI tools capable of reviewing large volumes of contracts, flagging non-standard clauses, identifying risk provisions, and benchmarking terms against market standards are increasingly being deployed by Nigerian firms handling high-volume transaction work. The application is particularly powerful in mergers and acquisitions due diligence, where hundreds of contracts may need review in compressed timeframes.



4.3 Court Filing and Case Management Systems

The digitisation of court processes has been one of the most consequential — and most uneven — technology developments in the Nigerian legal ecosystem. Electronic filing eliminates physical queues, reduces document loss, and creates more accurate and auditable court records.

| Court / Jurisdiction        | E-Filing Status       | Virtual Hearings | Digital Case Tracking |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|-----------------------|
| Supreme Court of Nigeria    | Limited               | Ad hoc           | Partial               |
| Court of Appeal             | Partial               | Available        | Partial               |
| Federal High Court          | Active (Lagos, Abuja) | Available        | Active                |
| Lagos State High Court      | Active                | Active           | Active                |
| Rivers State High Court     | Developing            | Limited          | Limited               |
| Kano State High Court       | Developing            | Limited          | Limited               |
| Magistrate Courts (General) | Minimal               | Rare             | Minimal               |

Source: Federal High Court Digital Transformation Report 2024; Lagos State Judiciary e-Filing Annual Report 2024.

The Federal High Court's e-filing portal and the Lagos State Judiciary's digital court registry are the most advanced implementations in the country. However, even in Lagos, technical glitches, server downtime, and practitioner resistance remain ongoing challenges.

4.4 Artificial Intelligence in Legal Functions

Artificial intelligence represents the frontier of legal technology and arguably the most transformative force reshaping the profession globally. In Nigeria, AI is beginning to penetrate legal practice across several dimensions.

AI-Assisted Legal Research

AI-powered semantic search and natural language processing tools allow practitioners to query databases conversationally — asking questions rather than entering keywords — and surface relevant authorities with greater precision and speed than traditional Boolean search methods.

AI Contract Review

Machine learning models trained on large contract corpora can review agreements, flag non-standard provisions, classify risk, and suggest market-standard alternatives. These tools are particularly valuable in transaction-heavy practices dealing with high volumes of documentation.

Predictive Analytics

A nascent but growing area involves using historical court data to model litigation outcomes. While the inconsistency and incompleteness of publicly available Nigerian case data currently limits accuracy, the direction of travel is clear. Firms and litigation funders globally are investing heavily in predictive litigation tools — and Nigeria will follow.

Generative AI for Drafting

Tools such as ChatGPT, Harvey, and Kourti's own AI-assisted drafting module are being used by Nigerian practitioners to assist with first drafts of legal documents, research summaries, client correspondence, and legal

opinions. The productivity benefits are real, but so are the risks: hallucinated citations, jurisdictional errors, and confidentiality concerns demand careful governance.

**Caution: Hallucination Risk**

*AI language models have been known to fabricate case citations — a phenomenon known as hallucination. Nigerian practitioners must verify all AI-generated legal authorities against authoritative databases before relying on them. Several international cases of courts sanctioning lawyers for citing non-existent AI-generated cases serve as cautionary examples. The NBA is expected to issue formal guidance on this matter in H1 2026.*

## 4.5 Cybersecurity and Data Privacy Compliance

The digitisation of legal practice brings with it profound cybersecurity and data privacy obligations. Law firms are custodians of some of the most sensitive information in existence: merger negotiations, litigation strategies, criminal defence details, financial transactions, and personal data of clients.

### The NDPA Framework

Nigeria's National Data Protection Act (NDPA) 2023 imposes data protection obligations directly relevant to legal practices. Lawyers processing personal data — as virtually all do — are data controllers under the law. Key obligations include:

- Maintaining a comprehensive record of processing activities
- Implementing appropriate technical and organisational security measures
- Conducting Data Protection Impact Assessments for high-risk processing activities
- Appointing a Data Protection Officer for large-scale processing operations
- Periodic compliance reporting to the Nigeria Data Protection Commission

### Cybersecurity Threats Facing Law Firms

Nigerian law firms face a range of cybersecurity threats including phishing attacks targeting client credentials, ransomware attacks that encrypt firm data, and business email compromise scams targeting financial transactions. Firms have begun investing in endpoint protection, multi-factor authentication, encrypted communications tools, and cybersecurity awareness training — though adoption remains uneven.

## 4.6 Legal Analytics and Business Intelligence

Beyond the practice of law itself, technology is transforming the business of law. Legal analytics tools that track matter profitability, realisation rates, client portfolio analysis, and fee earner performance are enabling law firm management to make evidence-based decisions. This is a relatively underdeveloped area in the Nigerian market, but one growing rapidly in importance.

## SECTION 5

# The Regulatory and Compliance Technology Landscape

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Nigeria's regulatory environment — complex, multi-layered, and evolving rapidly — is itself a major driver of technology adoption in legal practice. Compliance technology, commonly referred to as RegTech, is emerging as one of the fastest-growing segments of Nigerian legal technology.

## 5.1 Key Regulatory Developments Driving Technology Adoption

- **CAMA 2020:** The Companies and Allied Matters Act amendments introduced significant changes to corporate compliance requirements, including provisions enabling electronic meetings, e-signatures on company documents, and digital submissions to the Corporate Affairs Commission.
- **Finance Acts (2019–2024):** Annual amendments to Nigeria's tax laws have created ongoing compliance complexity, driving adoption of tax technology tools integrated with legal functions.
- **Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023:** The NDPA has created new obligations for legal professionals as data controllers and has accelerated demand for privacy compliance tooling.
- **Investment and Securities Act 2024:** Updated capital markets regulation creates new compliance demands for legal practices advising on securities transactions.
- **FIRS Digitisation:** The Federal Inland Revenue Service's progressive digitisation of tax filing, assessment, and dispute resolution has driven adoption of digital workflows in tax-facing practices.

## 5.2 The NBA's Technology Initiatives

The Nigerian Bar Association has signalled increasing awareness of technology's importance to the profession. Key initiatives in the current period include e-learning platforms for Continuing Legal Education credits, digital verification systems for practising certificates, ongoing engagement with courts on electronic filing standards, and legal technology programming through the Section on Business Law and the Institute for Advanced Legal Studies.

Critics note, however, that the NBA's technology strategy remains fragmented and insufficiently resourced relative to the scale of the transformation underway. Kourti calls on the NBA to accelerate its technology governance agenda in H1 2026.

SECTION 6

Technology Adoption by Sector

Technology adoption in Nigerian legal practice is highly uneven across sectors and firm types. This section maps the current state of adoption across key segments as at Q1 2026.

| Segment                         | Adoption Level  | Primary Tools Used               | Key Barriers         |
|---------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------|----------------------|
| Large Commercial Firms (Top 20) | High            | AI Research, CLM, DMS, Analytics | Governance, Cost     |
| Mid-Tier Firms                  | Moderate        | LawPavilion, E-Filing, PMS       | Budget, Skills       |
| Small Firms                     | Low to Moderate | Basic DMS, Google Workspace      | Cost, Awareness      |
| Sole Practitioners              | Low             | Word, Email, WhatsApp            | Cost, Infrastructure |
| In-House (Banks & Telcos)       | High            | CLM, RegTech, E-Sign, Analytics  | Legacy Systems       |
| In-House (Fintechs & Tech)      | Very High       | Modern SaaS Stack, AI Tools      | Vendor Selection     |
| In-House (Government)           | Low             | Manual and Paper-heavy Processes | Budget, Culture      |
| Judiciary (Federal Courts)      | Moderate        | E-Filing, Virtual Hearings       | Infrastructure       |
| Judiciary (State Courts)        | Low             | Minimal Digital Penetration      | Budget, Training     |

The table above illustrates the bifurcation of Nigeria's legal technology landscape: a digitally advanced upper tier and a largely undigitised majority. Bridging this divide is the central challenge for the sector over the next decade.

## SECTION 7

## Challenges and Barriers to Adoption

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Despite the clear benefits of technology adoption in legal practice, significant structural, cultural, and economic barriers continue to impede progress across large swaths of Nigeria's legal sector.

### 7.1 Infrastructure Deficits

Nigeria's technology infrastructure, while improving, remains a fundamental constraint. Unreliable power supply, inconsistent broadband internet connectivity, and high data costs disproportionately affect legal practitioners outside the major commercial centres. Cloud-based legal technology tools that require consistent, high-bandwidth internet access are effectively inaccessible to practitioners in many parts of the country.

### 7.2 Cost and Affordability

Enterprise-grade legal technology platforms are priced for the global market and often beyond the reach of individual practitioners or small firms in Nigeria. Annual licensing fees for major contract management platforms, document management systems, and AI research tools can represent a significant expense when margins are thin and the naira faces devaluation pressure.

### 7.3 Skills and Digital Literacy

Technology adoption requires not just the acquisition of tools, but the skills to use them effectively. Nigerian legal education has historically provided limited technology training. There is a meaningful gap between the availability of legal technology and the workforce's capacity to leverage it effectively.

### 7.4 Cultural Resistance

The legal profession has a well-documented tendency toward conservatism. Senior partners who built successful careers on paper-based practice may be reluctant to invest in tools that appear to challenge their established methodologies or billing models. The perception that technology will replace lawyers rather than augment them is a narrative that the sector must actively counter.

### 7.5 Data Security and Confidentiality Concerns

Legal professional privilege and confidentiality obligations are foundational to the lawyer-client relationship. Concerns about storing sensitive client data on third-party cloud servers — particularly servers located outside Nigeria — create legitimate hesitation about cloud-based legal technology adoption. However, the risk calculus must be honest: a paper-based or locally-stored solution is often less secure than a reputable cloud provider with robust security infrastructure.

### 7.6 Regulatory Ambiguity

The absence of comprehensive guidance from the NBA and the NJC on the governance of legal technology creates uncertainty that impedes adoption. Practitioners lack clear guidance on what AI tools may be used in legal work, how AI-generated content should be disclosed to courts and clients, and the professional responsibility implications of technology failures.

### 7.7 Vendor Ecosystem Immaturity

The Nigerian legal technology vendor ecosystem, while growing, remains immature relative to the size of the market. Too few vendors are building products specifically designed for the Nigerian legal environment — with

Nigerian case law, statutes, court procedures, and regulatory requirements as first-class design considerations.

### **The Opportunity in the Challenge**

*Every barrier identified in this section is also a market opportunity. The infrastructure deficit creates demand for offline-capable, low-bandwidth legal tools. The cost barrier creates space for affordable, naira-denominated SaaS solutions. The skills gap creates demand for legal technology training and consulting. Nigeria's legal technology ecosystem is not yet saturated. It is waiting to be built.*

## SECTION 8

## Opportunities and Recommendations

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The challenges outlined above do not diminish the opportunity — they define it. The following represents Kourti's assessment of the highest-impact opportunities for legal technology in Nigeria, and recommendations for the profession entering Q1 2026.

### 8.1 For Law Firms

- Develop a formal technology strategy: Every firm, regardless of size, should articulate a clear view of its technology priorities, budget, and implementation roadmap.
- Invest in foundational infrastructure first: Reliable computing hardware, secure internet connectivity, cloud backup, and cybersecurity basics must precede investment in advanced tools.
- Adopt a Nigerian legal research database as standard: Every practitioner should have access to a quality Nigerian legal research database — this is the non-negotiable baseline.
- Pilot AI tools with governance: Firms should experiment with AI tools under a clear policy governing disclosure, verification, confidentiality, and training requirements.
- Prioritise cybersecurity training: Human error remains the leading cause of data breaches. Regular cybersecurity awareness training is the highest-return security investment available.

### 8.2 For In-House Legal Teams

- Deploy CLM for contract standardisation: In-house teams should standardise on a contract lifecycle management platform to reduce cycle times and improve visibility.
- Build a legal operations function: Larger in-house teams should invest in dedicated legal operations capabilities focused on process improvement, technology, and performance metrics.
- Integrate with enterprise systems: Legal technology should connect with the organisation's broader ERP, CRM, and compliance systems for maximum value and efficiency.

### 8.3 For the NBA and Regulatory Bodies

- Issue technology governance guidance: The NBA should issue substantive guidance on the professional responsibility implications of legal technology use — particularly AI — in H1 2026.
- Reform legal education curricula: The Nigerian Law School and universities should integrate technology competency training into their programmes as a core requirement.
- Create a legal technology sandbox: The NBA, in partnership with technology providers, could create a structured environment for practitioners to test and evaluate tools safely.

### 8.4 For Legal Technology Vendors

- Build for Nigeria first: Vendors should invest in Nigerian-specific datasets, court integrations, and regulatory content rather than treating Nigeria as an adaptation of a global product.
- Price for the market: Tiered, naira-denominated pricing that serves sole practitioners and small firms — not just large firms and corporates — is essential for broad-based adoption.
- Invest in training and support: Technology adoption rates track directly with quality of onboarding and ongoing support infrastructure.



## SECTION 9

## The Future of Legal Technology in Nigeria

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Looking ahead, several technology trends will shape the evolution of Nigerian legal practice over the next five to ten years. Practitioners and institutions that understand these trajectories will be better positioned to adapt — and to lead.

### 9.1 Generative AI at Scale

Generative AI will move from a tool used informally by individual practitioners to an institutionalised capability embedded in law firm workflows. AI-assisted drafting, research, and due diligence will become table stakes for competitive practice. The differentiation will not be in having AI — but in how well firms use, govern, and quality-control AI outputs.

### 9.2 Smart Contracts and Blockchain

As Nigeria's digital economy continues to grow — particularly in fintech, real estate technology, and supply chain management — demand for blockchain-based smart contracts will increase. These self-executing contracts, encoded with performance conditions, have significant implications for transactional legal practice. The Investment and Securities Act 2024 provisions on digital assets signal regulatory awareness of this trajectory.

### 9.3 Virtual Courts and Digital Justice

Virtual hearings, initiated under pandemic necessity, will become normalised for appropriate case types — particularly preliminary hearings, routine procedural matters, and appeals. The economics are compelling: reduced time and cost for practitioners and litigants, improved access to justice for those in remote locations, and more efficient use of judicial resources.

### 9.4 Legal Marketplaces and Access to Justice

Technology is democratising access to legal services in Nigeria. Platforms connecting individuals and SMEs with lawyers are making legal services more accessible and transparent. This has profound implications for the structure of the legal market, particularly for general practice firms.

### 9.5 Data-Driven Practice Management

Law firms will increasingly compete on operational efficiency as much as legal expertise. Matter profitability, client lifetime value, pricing optimisation, and capacity management will be managed through data dashboards rather than instinct. Firms that build this capability will have structural cost and pricing advantages over those that do not.

### 9.6 RegTech Integration

The increasing complexity of Nigeria's regulatory environment across financial services, data protection, capital markets, and taxation will drive demand for integrated RegTech solutions that connect legal and compliance functions. Law firms advising in regulated sectors will increasingly be expected to advise not just on the law, but on the technology tools for compliance.

**The 2030 Vision**

*By 2030, leading Nigerian law firms will be indistinguishable in their technology infrastructure from their counterparts in London, New York, or Johannesburg. AI-augmented research, automated contract workflows, digital client portals, and data-driven firm management will be standard. The question is not whether this will happen. It is who will lead it.*

## SECTION 10

## Conclusion

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Technology is reshaping the legal profession — not in some distant future, but right now, in Q1 2026. In Nigeria, the transformation is underway. It is uneven, it is contested, and it faces real structural challenges. But the direction is clear, the business case is compelling, and the practitioners and institutions who move with purpose will define the next era of Nigerian legal practice.

The barriers are real: infrastructure, cost, skills, culture, and regulatory uncertainty. None of them are permanent. Infrastructure is improving. Costs are falling as the vendor ecosystem matures. Digital literacy is rising with each new cohort of law graduates. Culture shifts when leadership commits. Regulation follows practice.

What the Nigerian legal sector needs now is not more diagnosis of what holds it back, but more of what drives it forward. More founders building legal technology designed for the Nigerian market. More managing partners making technology investment a strategic priority. More educators integrating digital competencies into legal training. More regulators providing clear, practical guidance on technology governance.

Kourti exists to accelerate this transformation. We believe that Nigerian legal practitioners — known across the continent for their intellectual rigour, advocacy excellence, and tenacity — have everything it takes to lead the next chapter of legal technology in Africa. The tools are available. The market is ready. The time is now.

***“The future of Nigerian legal practice belongs to those who combine legal excellence with technological intelligence.”***

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## About Kourti

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Kourti is a next-generation legal operations platform built for Africa's legal professionals and organisations. We combine deep legal domain expertise with cutting-edge artificial intelligence to deliver tools, insights, and services that help lawyers work smarter, clients achieve better outcomes, and institutions operate with greater certainty.

Our work spans legal research, contract intelligence, compliance technology, and legal operations — all designed with the African legal market as a first-class design consideration, not an afterthought.

We partner with law firms, in-house legal teams, government institutions, and legal training organisations to drive adoption of technology that makes legal practice more efficient, more accessible, and more impactful.

## Connect with Kourti

**Website:** [www.kourti.com](http://www.kourti.com)

**LinkedIn:** [linkedin.com/company/kourti](https://linkedin.com/company/kourti)

**Email:** [hello@kourti.com](mailto:hello@kourti.com)

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